CODE OF SAFE PRACTICES

The Hays Companies Group | Chapter 4 of the Health and Safety Manual, issued as a standalone posting | v1.2, Effective October 1, 2026 | Revised October 15, 2026

This Code is posted at each job location and reviewed at orientation and in regular safety meetings. It states minimum requirements; the Health and Safety Manual and the pre-task plan govern the details of each task.

GENERAL SAFE PRACTICES

1. All work is performed under this Code, the Health and Safety Manual, and the pre-task plan (JHA) for the task. The plan names the heaviest or most repetitive manual handling, the aid or method to be used, and who rotates. When the work changes, the plan changes first.

2. Every employee has the authority and the duty to stop any work they believe is unsafe. No employee will be disciplined for a good-faith stop or report.

3. Report every injury, near miss, and instance of property, equipment, or utility damage to your supervisor before the end of the shift.

4. Report to work fit for duty: free of impairment from alcohol, drugs, medications that impair, and fatigue. Disclose impairing medications before the shift.

5. Required PPE is worn in all designated areas: hard hat, safety glasses, high-visibility apparel, safety-toe boots, and gloves suited to the task, plus task-specific PPE per the plan.

6. Horseplay, fighting, and pranks are prohibited on all work premises.

7. Keep work areas clean as the work proceeds: walkways clear, cords and hoses out of paths, nails removed or bent, materials stacked stable, spills cleaned or guarded immediately.

8. Inspect tools and equipment before use. Defective tools and equipment are tagged out of service and turned in, never used carefully.

9. Machine guards and safety devices stay in place and functional. Removing or defeating a guard is a serious violation.

10. Cord-connected tools operate on GFCI protection. Damaged cords are removed from service; grounding pins are never removed.

11. Ladders are inspected before use, set on firm level footing, and climbed with three points of contact facing the ladder. Consider a lift or scaffold before choosing a ladder.

12. Use mechanical means or a lifting aid first: forklift, dolly, cart, hoist, or the aid named in the plan. One person lifts no more than 50 pounds alone under good conditions; 50 to 100 pounds is a team lift or mechanical; over 100 pounds is mechanical, always. Keep loads close and turn with the feet, not the back. Rotate high-repetition and high-vibration tasks where the work allows. Report aches, pain, numbness, tingling, or loss of grip to your supervisor the same day; reporting is never disciplined.

13. Never dry-cut, dry-grind, or dry-sweep concrete, masonry, or asphalt. Use water or vacuum dust controls, always.

14. Wear hearing protection in posted areas and around high-noise equipment.

15. Follow the heat illness prevention program: drink water throughout the shift, use shade, take cool-down rests when needed, and watch coworkers for symptoms.

16. Know the emergency plan for your location: alarm, muster point, and who calls 911. Never move a seriously injured person except to prevent further injury, and never drive yourself for treatment of a serious injury.

17. Seatbelts are worn in every vehicle and every machine so equipped. Handheld phone use while operating is prohibited. A spotter is required whenever backing or offloading where any person could be in the path or vision is limited. Working alone, a documented walk-around immediately before the move is the accepted alternative.

18. Only trained and authorized employees operate equipment, machinery, or vehicles, or perform work requiring certification.

OFFICE SAFE PRACTICES

19. Keep walkways, aisles, and exits clear; close drawers; route cords out of walk paths; clean or guard spills immediately.

20. Access storage with a stepstool or ladder using three points of contact, never a chair, box, or desk.

21. Move boxes and supplies with carts first and team lifts for awkward loads.

22. Arrange workstations ergonomically, take movement breaks, and request an ergonomic review when needed. Report discomfort symptoms to your supervisor the same day; reporting is never disciplined.

JOBSITE VISITS

23. Comply with the host site's orientation, escort, and PPE requirements: hard hat, safety glasses, Class 2 high-visibility apparel, and appropriate footwear, issued before departure.

24. Remain with the escort and outside active work areas; never walk under loads or behind operating equipment.

Stop work authority applies to every rule above. Questions, hazards, and anonymous reports: Corporate Safety, Sergio Robles, 626-366-2912.